Handout 1-C: Motivation Statement Worksheet

Session 3 · about 35 minutes, including writing and revising your paragraph

Self-Determination Theory (SDT) says motivation lasts when three needs are met: **autonomy** (you have some choice), **competence** (you can grow), and **relatedness** (you feel connected to others). This worksheet helps you see which need is running low, then write a short statement of why you're here.

Part 1: Rate your three needs

Need	Rating (1–5)	One reason for this rating
Autonomy (I have some choice)		
Competence (I can grow)		
Relatedness (I'm connected to others)		

My weakest need right now: …

One small thing that would strengthen it this week: …

Part 2: Scaffolding prompts

Use these prompts as scaffolding, then integrate your answers into one paragraph (4–8 sentences) that you can revise.

- Why did I choose (or am I choosing) this path?
- What do I want this stretch to feel like on a good day?
- What do I want to avoid (exhaustion? the same frustration as last time?)?
- Who is on my team, even if it's just "me, three months from now"?
- If I could only remember one sentence from this course, what would it be?

Stuck? Try the three SDT questions: (a) What do I want to choose? (b) What skill do I want to improve? (c) Who do I want to be around while I do this? Let your weakest need guide which one you start with.

Notes

- **Cultural note.** Not every "why" is individualistic. Collective motivations (family, community, faith) are fully valid expressions of relatedness. You don't need a "grind-it-out" story, and your statement doesn't have to sound excited to be true.
- **Options.** Written paragraph, a 1-minute voice memo, or a 3-minute audio version where the three SDT questions are read aloud to you and you answer out loud. For the voice route, "revising" means recording a second take after you listen back.

Worked example

Need	Rating (1–5)	One reason for this rating
Autonomy	4	I chose this certificate and I set my own study hours.
Competence	3	I’m learning, but I don’t know yet if I can pass the exam.
Relatedness	2	I’m studying alone and haven’t talked to anyone about it.

Weakest need: Relatedness.

One small thing that would strengthen it this week: Tell one friend what I’m studying and ask if I can text them when I finish a session.

Sample statement (shortened): “I’m doing this because I want a steadier job for my family, and because I’m tired of feeling stuck. On a good day this stretch feels calm and a little proud, not frantic. I want to avoid burning out the way I did last time. My team is my sister, who checks in on me, and me three months from now, who will be glad I kept going.”